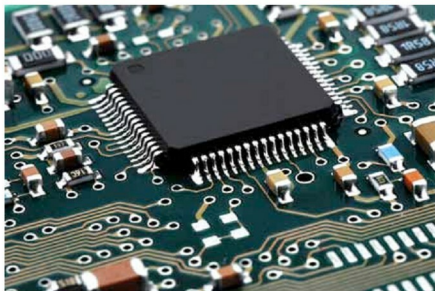


Worldwide semiconductor sales to go up by 4.5 per cent in 2013

Worldwide semiconductor revenue is projected to total \$311 billion in 2013—a 4.5 per cent increase from 2012. Semiconductor revenue for 2012 is expected to total \$298 billion—down 3 per cent from 2011.

“The looming fiscal cliff, ongoing European debt crisis, slower emerging market growth and regional tensions have all played a part in reduced growth projections for semiconductor revenue in both 2012 and 2013,” said Peter Middleton, principal analyst at Gartner. “Inventory levels were already high at the start of the second half of 2012, and as PC demand rolled off, supply simply overshot demand.”

The semiconductor market was further depressed when DRAM prices failed to rebound in 2012. Gartner predicts that the DRAM market will not recover until the second half of 2013, when lower supply growth is expected to pull the market into a period of undersupply.



Semiconductor revenue for 2012 is expected to be 3 per cent down from 2011

Samsung promotes Lee to vice chairman

Samsung Electronics has promoted its chairman's son to vice chairman. The company, part of Samsung Group, said Jay Y. Lee's appointment was part of an annual reshuffle. The 44-year-old Jay Lee has contributed to the firm's explosive growth in the smartphone sector. Jay Lee was already chief operating officer and president at the firm.

Dr Berns appointed as MD Bosch

Bosch Group has named Dr Steffen Berns as managing director of Bosch

Limited and president of Bosch Group in India. The announcement was made after the board meeting of Bosch Limited in Goa. Dr Berns will also lead the operations of Bosch Group in India.

Salehpour joins Applied Materials

Applied Materials has combined its two business units—Energy and Environmental Solutions (EES) and Display—under one leader. Ali Salehpour has joined the company as group vice president and general manager of the EES and Display groups.

LED lighting market to double by 2015

According to a recent IMS report, the LED market will peak at \$13.5 billion in 2015 but remain relatively flat after that. The main reason for stagnant growth is LEDs' tendency to last long.

The current market size of LEDs is projected at about \$10.9 billion, with \$2.9 billion in lighting and \$8 billion in other applications. By 2015, the market will comprise \$5.8 billion in lighting,

thereby doubling in three years, and \$7.7 billion in other areas.

According to IMS, the total packaged LED market revenue is expected to fall towards the end of the decade once the general lighting market peaks. There are, however, a number of factors that could change the outlook, notably if adoption is slower than predicted over the next three or four years. In this alternative scenario, growth would be slower initially but could be maintained for a longer period throughout the decade.

On the overall front, television is the second largest market for packaged LEDs, which is expected to grow slightly from \$2.0 billion in 2012 to \$2.4 billion by 2016.

Window 8 to drive ultrabook sales

Low ultrabook sales in the first half of 2012 undermined Intel's bullish '40 per cent of notebook' claims early last year. Higher-than-expected device prices, wait for Windows 8, and a sluggish global economy hindered sales of the new thin and light portable computers. Nevertheless, after the launch of Windows 8 and release of a host of new ultrabook models, shipments are estimated to have increased to twenty-one